

■ English Consonant Sounds

There are 24 consonant sounds in English.

Each sound has its phonetic symbol, examples, and transcriptions.

1. /p/ – Voiceless bilabial plosive

Examples: pen → /pen/, people → /piˈpəl/, cup → /kʌp/

2. /b/ – Voiced bilabial plosive

Examples: boy → /bɔɪ/, baby → /beɪbi/, cab → /kæb/

3. /t/ – Voiceless alveolar plosive

Examples: tea → /tiː/, table → /teɪbəl/, cat → /kæt/

4. /d/ – Voiced alveolar plosive

Examples: dog → /dɒg/, door → /dɔː/, bad → /bæd/

5. /k/ – Voiceless velar plosive

Examples: cat → /kæt/, cook → /kʊk/, kick → /kɪk/

6. /g/ – Voiced velar plosive

Examples: goat → /ɡəʊt/, game → /ɡeɪm/, bag → /bæg/

7. /f/ – Voiceless labiodental fricative

Examples: fish → /fɪʃ/, coffee → /kəfi/, leaf → /liːf/

8. /v/ – Voiced labiodental fricative

Examples: van → /væn/, give → /ɡɪv/, seven → /sevən/

9. /θ/ – Voiceless dental fricative

Examples: think → /θɪŋk/, thank → /θæŋk/, thief → /θiːf/

10. /ð/ – Voiced dental fricative

Examples: this → /ðɪs/, those → /ðəʊz/, father → /fɑːðə/

11. /s/ – Voiceless alveolar fricative

Examples: sun → /sʌn/, snake → /sneɪk/, bus → /bʌs/

12. /z/ – Voiced alveolar fricative

Examples: zoo → /zuː/, rose → /rəʊz/, noise → /nɔɪz/

13. /ʃ/ – Voiceless palato-alveolar fricative

Examples: shoe → /ʃuː/, sheep → /ʃiːp/, nation → /neɪʃən/

14. /ʒ/ – Voiced palato-alveolar fricative

Examples: measure → /meʒə/, television → /telɪvɪʒən/, usual → /juːʒuəl/

15. /h/ – Voiceless glottal fricative

Examples: hat → /hæt/, house → /haʊs/, behind → /bɪhaɪnd/

16. /tʃ/ – Voiceless palato-alveolar affricate

Examples: church → /tʃɜːtʃ/, cheese → /tʃiːz/, teacher → /ˈtiːtʃə/

17. /dʒ/ – Voiced palato-alveolar affricate

Examples: judge → /dʒʌdʒ/, jam → /dʒæm/, village → /ˈvɪlɪdʒ/

18. /m/ – Bilabial nasal

Examples: man → /mæn/, summer → /ˈsʌmər/, time → /taɪm/

19. /n/ – Alveolar nasal

Examples: nose → /nəʊz/, name → /neɪm/, dinner → /ˈdɪnər/

20. /ŋ/ – Velar nasal

Examples: sing → /sɪŋ/, long → /lɒŋ/, ringing → /ˈrɪŋŋ/

21. /l/ – Alveolar lateral approximant

Examples: leg → /leg/, little → /ˈlɪtl/, yellow → /ˈjel/

22. /r/ – Alveolar approximant

Examples: red → /red/, river → /ˈrɪvər/, around → /əˈraʊnd/

23. /j/ – Palatal approximant

Examples: yes → /jes/, yellow → /ˈjel/, yard → /jɑːd/

24. /w/ – Labio-velar approximant

Examples: we → /wi/, water → /ˈwɔːtər/, queen → /kwiːn/

Assignment:

Write each word that contains these Consonant Sounds.